

Scan a label at the Getty Villa and your family becomes Olympic athletes in Roblox, rescuing Hermes by playing contests built around the real objects in the galleries.

ZIntensive Imagination

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THE MUSEUM AND THE PLAYER

A free museum of the ancient world, about to host the Games

WHAT THE GETTY DOES NOW

Family quests are on paper or audio: Art Detective trivia cards, the Percy Jackson–inspired “Demigods” quest, an Odyssey tour, the Family Forum. No game yet.

THE PROBLEM ON OUR CARD

Most visitors are locals. With LA hosting the 2028 Games, the Villa wants families to link its antiquities to the Olympics, on site, easy to finish, with a reward.

OUR PLAYER

The whole family on one phone: the child plays, the grown-up reads the label. Families already come. Kids who live on Roblox are the part they miss.

The Getty Villa from the air, Pacific Palisades, Los Angeles

THE STORY

Hades took Hermes. Zeus needs a champion.

- Every four years, wars stopped for the Games. Jealous Hades kidnapped Hermes, the Custodian of the Games, and locked him in the underworld.

- **WHAT BECOMES PLAY**
  The Villa itself, rebuilt in Roblox, and its athletic treasures: prize jars, the bronze Victorious Youth, a gold laurel wreath.

- **WHO YOU GET TO BE**
  An athlete of the ancient Games. Pick a guide: Hercules for action contests, Athena for puzzles at the objects. Collect leaves to restore the victor’s wreath and break Hades’ seal.



Concept art: Hades guards the sealed gate, AI-generated by the team

THE CORE LOOP

Find it. Look at it. Play it. Keep it.

1 Find

Follow glowing leaves to a gallery and scan the QR on the label.

2 Look

Spot a detail on the real object while the grown-up reads the label.

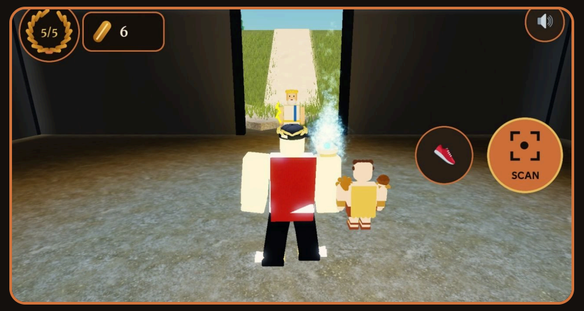
3 Play

A 90-second contest of the event painted on it.

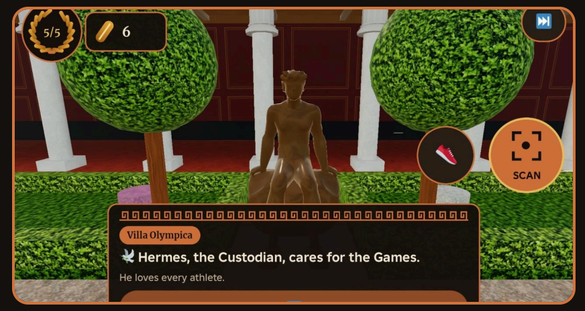
4 Collect

Leaves, a sprig of the wreath, upgrades, a place on the board.

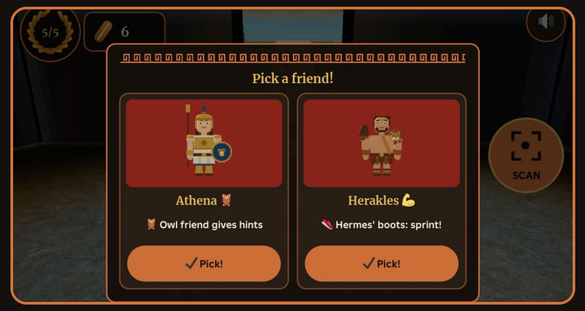
STORYBOARD: THE FIRST 10 MINUTES



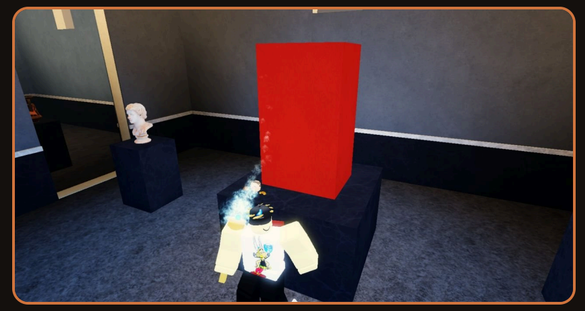
0:00 Scan the first label. Zeus waits at the door.



0:30 Hades has taken Hermes. Win the Games to free him.



1:30 Pick a guide: Hercules or Athena.



2:30 The game copy stays veiled until you scan the real jar in Gallery 104.



5:00 Chariot race against Apollo, like the one painted on the jar.



6:30 Win: a sprig for the wreath and a shower of leaves.



8:00 Spend leaves on a cape, a flame, a pet.



9:30 Your time on the Hall of Victors. Next object, next gallery.

Screenshots from our Roblox build. Built during the hackathon: we rebuilt the whole Getty Villa in Roblox, with its rooms, part of the collection and the terrain.



05 · THE VISIT

THE VISIT

Played during the visit. Kept going after it.

DURING, 25–40 MINUTES

Contests unlock by scanning at the object. The game points, the museum shows. Winners get a victor certificate on screen; we propose an olive-leaf sticker at the info desk.

AFTER, AT HOME

Replay contests to beat your records, upgrade your athlete and climb the leaderboard.

WHY COME BACK

Weekly and all-time leaderboards today. Next: new collectibles to restore each season, challenges with friends and family, and challenges that change with each exhibition, building to LA28. Entry is free.

Gallery 111, Getty Villa. © J. Paul Getty Trust

THE IMPACT

Kids look longer, and we can prove they learned

Most museum visitors spend well under a minute with an artwork (Smith, Smith & Tinio, 2017). Here every reward depends on looking.

WHAT THE PLAYER LEARNS

The olive wreath was the only Olympic prize. Prize jars held Athena's olive oil. The five pentathlon events. Athletes oiled and scraped their skin. Herakles founded the Games in myth.

WHAT THE MUSEUM CAN MEASURE

Logged today: the same question at the start and in the final riddle, first-try answers about each real object, and progress from first scan to crown. Next: return visits, from the scan dates we already save.



Entry Pavilion, Getty Villa. Photo: Wikimedia Commons



IN-GAME SCREENSHOT

Built during the hackathon: we rebuilt the whole Getty Villa in Roblox, with its rooms, part of the collection and the terrain.

START SMALL

Launch with two contests in one gallery

VERSION 1

Hercules' path: the chariot race and the javelin at two vases in Gallery 104, then the crown at the Victorious Youth in Gallery 111. Three QR labels, about 20 minutes.

STATUS TODAY

- 5 CONTESTS PLAYABLE
- QR AND CODE WORDS
- LEAVES AND SHOP
- LEADERBOARDS
- ANALYTICS
- TO DO: UPDATE OBJECT LABELS
- CHAT OFF
- GETTY SIGN-OFF

HOW IT GROWS

Three more contests, Athena's puzzles, then seasons with new collectibles and family challenges, up to live events at LA28, 14–30 July 2028.

SAFE AND EASY

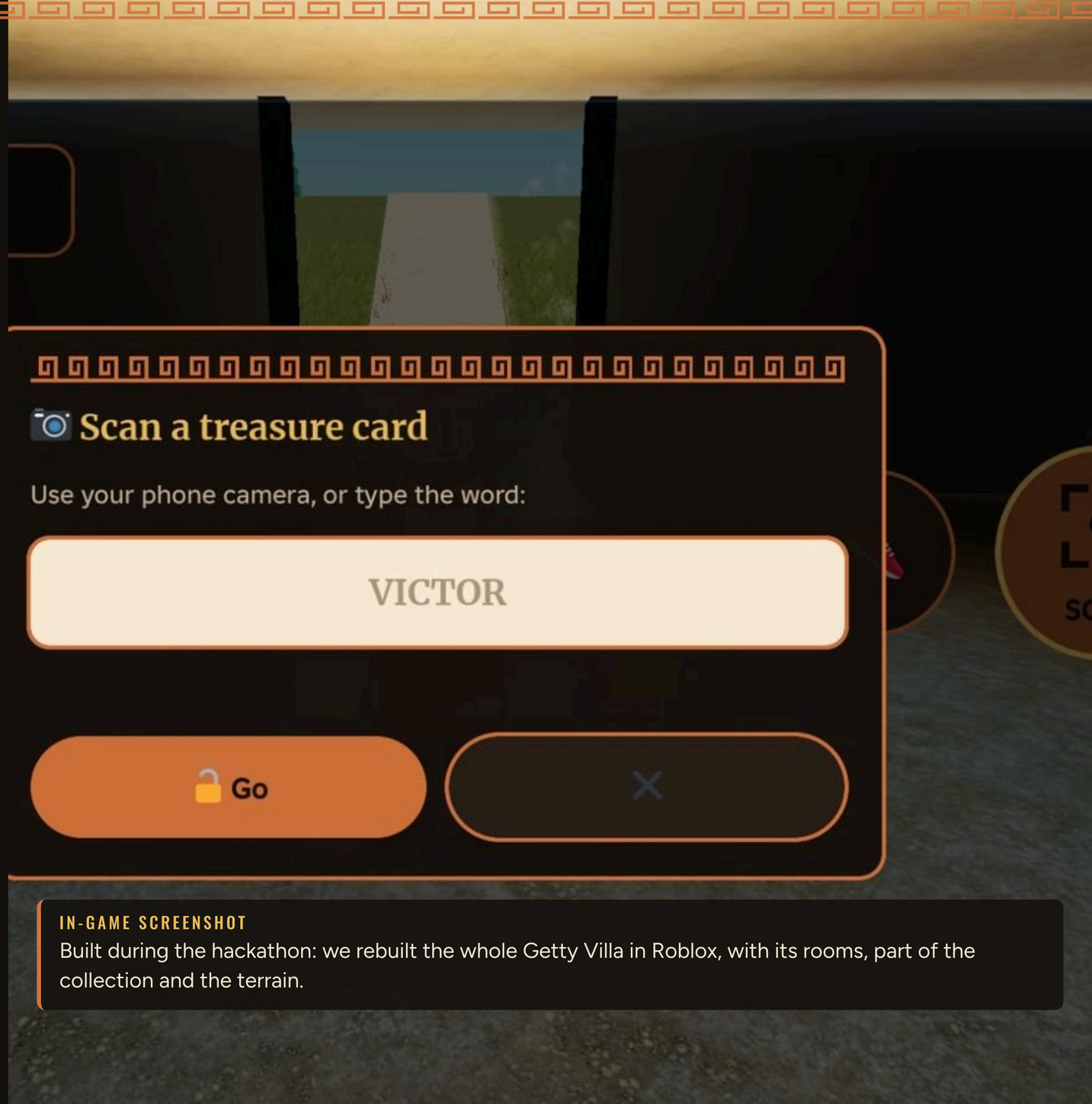
Scan, tap, play. Nothing to type, nothing to buy.

FIRST-TIME PLAYER
The QR opens Roblox straight in the game and unlocks that object. Picture answers, one big button, sound off in the galleries.

CHAT
We switch chat off in the game. Roblox also keeps chat off by default for accounts aged 5–8.

SPENDING
Only bay leaves earned by playing and scanning. No Robux, no ads, no loot boxes.

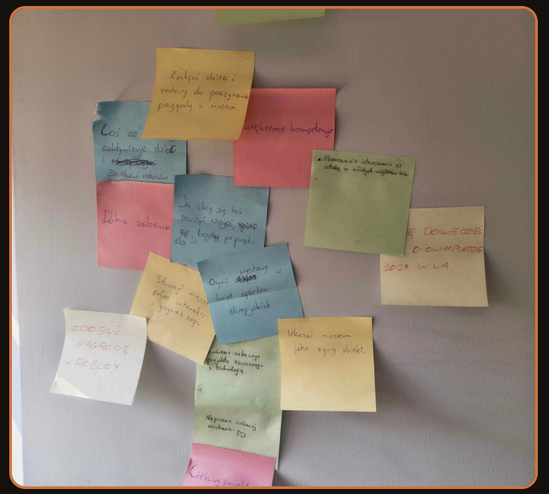
AGE
Family mode for all ages: picture answers, a grown-up corner, time attack for teens. Built for a Minimal rating, which can reach Roblox Kids (5–8) and Select (9–15).

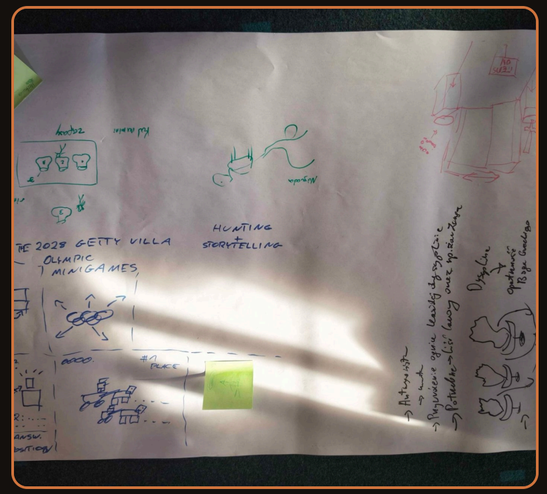


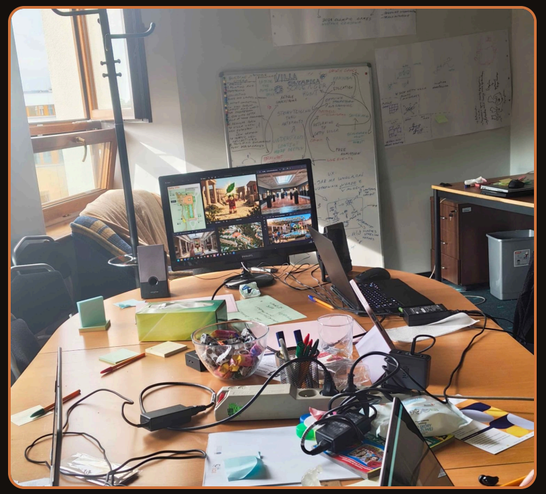
IN-GAME SCREENSHOT
Built during the hackathon: we rebuilt the whole Getty Villa in Roblox, with its rooms, part of the collection and the terrain.

From a wall of ideas to one scavenger hunt









SHORTLIST AND WHY IT WON

Scavenger hunt, storytelling through artefacts, PvP duels, brainrot “steal” games, AR or mixed reality, live events for 2028. The hunt with a story won most votes: it fits the Villa’s paper hunts, works with a QR on a label and gives every object a story.

AFTER FEEDBACK FROM BROKEN EGG AND XOLBOR

“Hard to fit in a manageable project” → launch with two contests. “Connect to the museum’s identity” → each contest is the event painted on a real object. “Be aware of time” → 90-second contests.

WHAT WE KEPT FROM THE VILLA’S PAPER QUESTS

We studied the Getty Villa’s family quests on paper and turned each part into play. The card held at an object → a QR label. Its “look closely” question → a picture question about the real object. The grown-up reading aloud → the grown-up corner. The finish at the desk → a victor certificate.

Photos from our on-site workshop

APPENDIX · ALL TEN QUESTS, THEIR REAL OBJECTS AND THEIR STATUS

Two guides, ten quests, one wreath

HERCULES' PATH · ACTION CONTESTS

Chariot race · Apollo — PLAYABLE · V1
Prize jar with an armed chariot race, 79.AE.147 · Gallery 104

Javelin · Achilles — PLAYABLE · LINK OBJECT
Cup with youths training at javelin, discus and long jump (outside), 85.AE.25 · Gallery 104

Long jump and discus · Hephaestus — NOT BUILT
Lidded box with athletes, 86.AE.142 · Gallery 104

Wrestling · Ares — PLAYABLE
Bronze bucket with wrestlers and a judge, 96.AC.41 · Gallery 206

Stadion run · Dionysus — PLAYABLE
Lansdowne Herakles, said to have founded the Games, 70.AA.109 · Gallery 108

ATHENA'S PATH · PUZZLES AT THE OBJECTS

Mend the vase — NOT BUILT
Jar with Herakles and the boar, rebuilt from fragments, 86.AE.83 · Gallery 103

Find the attributes — NOT BUILT
Judgment of Paris: Hera, Athena, Aphrodite, Hermes, 83.AE.10 · Gallery 104

Market maths · Demeter — NOT BUILT
Athens coin with Athena's owl, 2015.5 · Gallery 101D. 2 oil + 1 jar + 3 cloaks = 35 drachmas

River crossing — NOT BUILT
Achilles and Ajax playing a board game, 71.AE.441 · Gallery 103

Dress to impress the gods — NOT BUILT
Herakles 70.AA.109 · Zeus 73.AA.32 · Hermes 79.AA.132

Finale · Victor's crown — PLAYABLE · V1
Balance pose and the Riddle of Hades at the Victorious Youth 77.AB.30, beside a gold laurel wreath 92.AM.89 · Gallery 111

"Link object": the build still points the javelin at a cup that is no longer on view. Athena already guides players in the game by giving hints. Objects checked as on view in Getty's collection data, 8 October 2026. Sources: data.getty.edu · getty.edu/visit/villa · Roblox Creator Hub (Content maturity; Roblox Kids and Select) · Smith, Smith & Tinio (2017), *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts* 11(1) · la28.org. The concept art on slide 3 shows the Olympic rings; the game does not use them, and the final art needs a licence check.